2025

UX/UI DESIGN PORTFOLIO

Lara Lopes

About

With a background in Design, my passion for UX/UI has been evolving through multiple hands-on projects with an interest in **directing technology to social impact**, having complemented my bachelor's with an additional UX/UI course in 2024. I am particularly driven to **building and lead strong and lasting design strategies in a multi-disciplinary team**, in order to create experiences that truly make a difference. Although my focus has been on digital projects, my understanding of UX goes beyond the digital space. I believe **its benefits are at the core of our contemporary society**.

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Location: Chamusca, Portugal

Stomazing

Conceptual Project
dec'24 - jan'25

OVERVIEW

While looking for an opportunity to practice skills, I came across a briefing to create a platform for a *"new business that sells quirky stoma bag covers"*. During the first readings I tought there was an opportunity to do something else.

Stomazing was the result, a platform to support and empower individuals living with a stoma - as well as their caregivers.

"There is an estimated 13.5 million people worldwide living with a stoma, yet **it is rarely discussed** and, in many was, **a hidden condition"**

To gain firsthand perspectives from patients and caregivers, I explored testimonials, personal stories, and discussions (e.g., Patient Story, Crohn's Foundation)

"Many young people choose to hide their experiences because it is easy to conceal - **it's invisible**"

"I have a love-hate relationship with my stoma and I try to be kind to myself. (...) **We feel like there's shame involved** in talking about it"

"I feel so out of control. Being a patient is tough and being a caregiver is tough. **Both in very different ways.**"

"(...) and I knew well what a stoma was, **but I did not know anyone who had a stoma**"

"My mind is still trying to grasp how does somebody goes through this and keep going, part of **my success in it is truly just seeing other people do it**. We just gotta keep changing how we talk about this stuff."

"My wife has a colostomy. We all say that the **physical toil is nothing as bad as the emotional one**"

Key takeaways

Themes like stigma, **isolation**, and the **need for community** support stood out repeatedly

Caregivers face their own set of challenges as well, so it's important to consider them too

The emotional aspect can be **just as difficult to deal with**, if not more so at times

So, which platforms do users turn to?

Based on my findings, Meet an Ostomate and Reddit are the most well-known and widely used platforms. I evaluated the aspects I found to be the most relevant.

Aspects	DIRECT COMPETITOR Meet An Ostomate	INDIRECT COMPETITOR Reddit - r/ostomy
Approach	1:1 connections and forum	Open, fast-paced discussions
Navigation	Lacks organization despite having categorized forums	Unstructured, relies on searching through long threads
Support	Primarily patient-focused	Some caregiver participation, but no dedicated space
User Experience	Outdated, minimal UI	Standard Reddit interface, not tailored to possible ostomy needs
Key Topics	Personal reflections, strong usage of photos, experience sahring	Advice, product reccomendation, troubleshooting

Opportunities

1. Create **spaces for both sides** - patients and caregivers
2. **Affinity-based approach** can help surface the most relevant content
3. A **better structured** platform to avoid long searches
4. Since **product reviews** are a common topic, **centralizing** them allows for quick, reliable insights

Imagine Amber and David

Amber Minter, 28yo
Children's book illustrator

Recently, a persistent pain led to a diagnosis where she will need a permanent stoma. She **worries how this change will affect her daily life and what the future holds**.

Motivation
She wants to hear real experiences to feel more at ease with what to expect

Frustrations
She lacks connections and struggles to find first-hand advice relevant to her situation

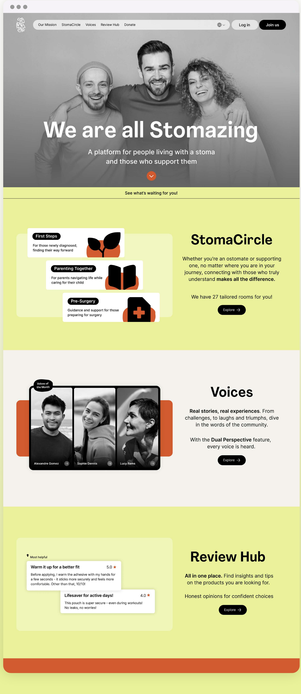
David Moore, 34yo
Teacher

As a single father, David has been raising his daughter, who has a stoma, since she was very young. Although he doesn't often talk about it, he **wishes he didn't feel so alone in his journey**.

Motivation
He's looking for advice and support from others who've cared for a loved one with a stoma

Frustrations
Most platforms focus on ostomates, making it hard to find guidance as a parent

How might we make it easier for Amber and David to navigate support networks and engage with content and people relevant to their journey?

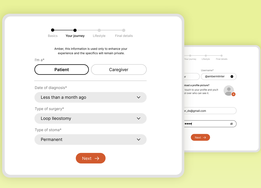


Affinity Rings

While existing platforms are valid as they are, the reality is that the numerous reasons why a person might need a stoma, different types of stoma and lifestyles, means that what works for some might not be suitable for another.

So, how can we quickly **provide users the reassurance that they are engaging with someone whose background closely aligns with hers?**

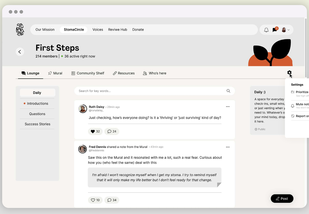
By visually showing how compatible one member is with another. As you will see, these rings are a valuable tool across the entire platform.



StomaCircle

StomaCircle is the heart of the platform, **structured as digital 'rooms' inspired by real-life spaces**.

This way, Amber and David can enter any room of their interest, knowing that **the conversations and resources inside are tailored**.



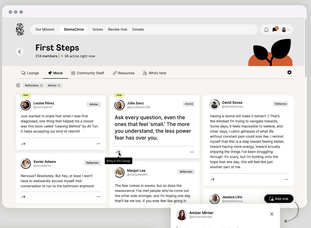
When users enter a room, they can explore:

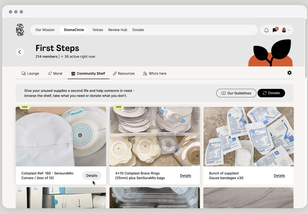
the Lounge

A space for conversations to unfold naturally, time-sensitive. In settings, users can choose to prioritize content from high-affinity members.

the Mural

A **quiet board** where members leave tips, advices, reflections - anonymously, if preferred. If someone wants to discuss a note, they can bring it to the Lounge for a real-time conversation.



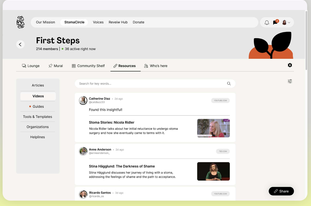


the Shelf

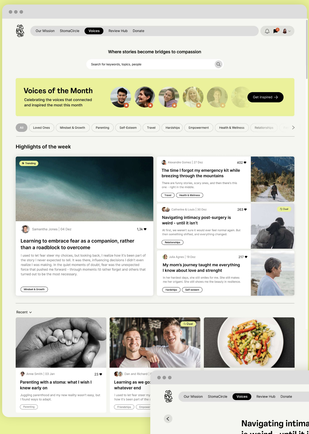
Allows members to share stoma-related supplies they no longer need, creating a space for **practical support**.

and the Resources

This section in each room keeps **valuable links** - articles, videos, organizations, and more - organized and easily accessible for members.



Beyond StomaCircle, Amber and David can explore spaces created to offer both comfort and guidance along the way



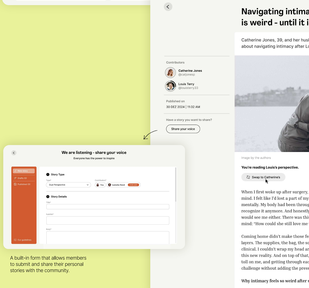
Voices

A curated space where users can read what their community have to say about their learnings, hardships or just about life in general.

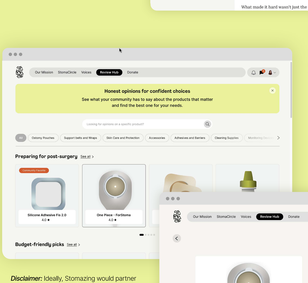
the Dual Narrative

feature **captures the shared yet individual experiences**, offering a richer and more complete story. Whether it's an ostomate and their partner, a parent and their child, or even two friends, this feature lets both voices be heard.

Users can swap between perspectives.



A built-in form that allows members to submit and share their personal stories with the community.



Review Hub

Users can now **find product reviews and tips more efficiently** without the need of digging through threads. Affinity rings help users see if reviews come from similar backgrounds, making them more relevant.

Disclaimer: Ideally, Stomazing would partner with ostomy brands to feature their products. These illustrations serve as placeholders due to limited stock images.

Hexabot

An app to help lunar pioneers manage their Hexabots

UX/UI challenge
15 - 18 February'25

In a parallel universe, humanity has been establishing settlements on the Moon for the better part of a decade and everyday life would be impossible without Hexabots - multi-purpose robots. The challenge was to create an app to help lunar pioneers manage these Hexabots **in an effortless and efficient manner**.

Deliverables: Wireflow (max. 12 screens) | 3 high-fidelity screens

The **insights** that set the stage

65%
of users assign new tasks in **response to urgent needs**

Users **are often multitasking**, they need efficiency

Not all users are technical experts, the interactions need to be **as simple as possible**

They operate in challeging conditions **with limited dexterity**

7-10 times
a day users **check the status of their Hexabots** to ensure tasks are progressing as planned

User's preferences

Voice-commands
Interest in hands-free control

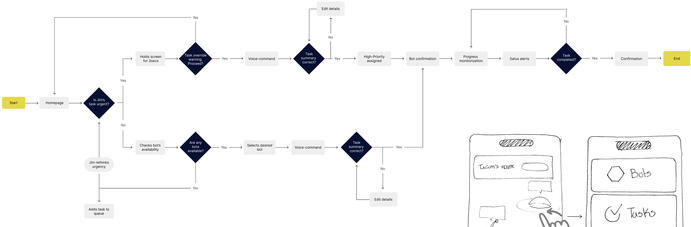
Personalization
Interest in naming and costumize bots

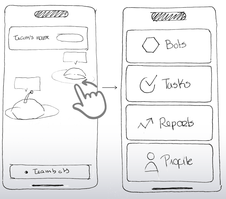
Clear task allocation

A mission on the moon **Jim's task**

Jim and his research team are working on a prototype turbine using a silicon 3D printer. However, they lack the specific materials and Jim needs to **quickly ensure that a hexabot is tasked with gathering the necessary resources.**

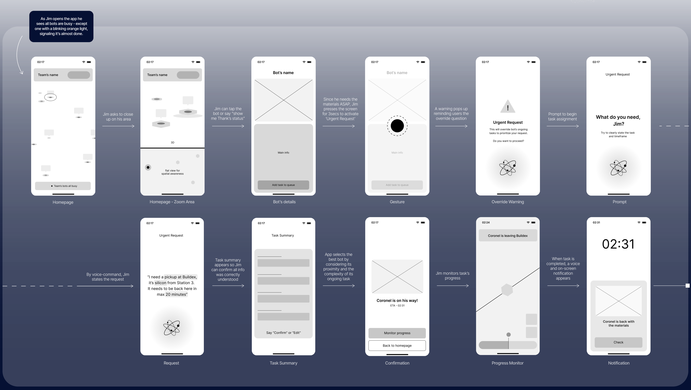
Since time was the biggest constraint (3 days), my game plan was to **define the task flowchart, sketch the twelve chosen screens, build the wireflow,** and **bring those three screens to life.**





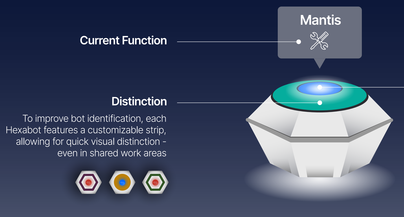
Designed for enhanced accessibility in low-dexterity environments, **the navigation menu features larger, easy-to-tap buttons** instead of a traditional compact layout.

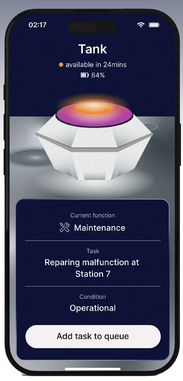
Gesture interactions are also prioritized for quick actions - swiping left near the edges opens the menu, swiping right returns to the previous screen, dragging in the center adjusts the map view, and holding the screen for three seconds activates the urgent request feature.



Next stop: UI

For this challenge, I chose to base the app on illustrations, aiming to create a more immersive experience

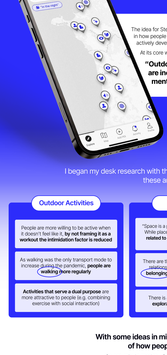




Step Out

An app designed to enhance engagement with local surroundings

Conceptual Project
Jul'24 - Aug'24



The idea for Step Out first emerged in 2022, shaped by a post-pandemic shift in how people engage with outdoor spaces. But it wasn't until last year that I actively developed it into what it is today.

At its core was the challenge of creating something based on this premise:

"Outdoor activities, in the post-pandemic context, are increasingly important for the physical and mental health of the population."

I began my desk research with the goal of knowing more about the key topics, these are **the main insights**

Outdoor Activities

People are more willing to be active when it doesn't feel like it, **by not framing it as a workout the intimidation factor is reduced**

As walking was the only transport mode by increase during the pandemic, **people are walking more regularly**

Activities that serve a dual purpose are more attractive to people (e.g. combining exercise with social interaction)

Spaces

"Space is a physical and absolute concept. While place is an intangible, it is **concept related to the sense and perception of the world"**

There are three concepts that shape our relationship with a space: **sense of belonging**, awareness and behavioral interaction

There is an increased **value of local exploration** after the pandemic.

Post-Pandemic

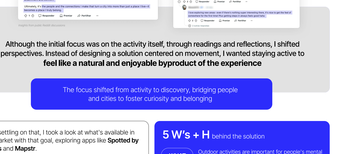
With pandemic also getting named as "The Loneliness Epidemic", people **are led to a strong desire to reconnect.**

More than interpersonal relationships, people are craving **sensory and spatial experiences** that were limited.

At the same time, some people may be dealing with **social anxiety** after lockdown.

With some ideas in mind, I wanted to get a better sense of how people feel about wandering

So, naturally, I turned to... Reddit. No joke, I find it's actually a goldmine for silently observing and gathering unfiltered perspectives



Although the initial focus was on the activity itself, through readings and reflections, I shifted perspectives. Instead of designing a solution centered on movement, I wanted staying active to **feel like a natural and enjoyable byproduct of the experience**

The focus shifted from activity to discovery, bridging people and cities to foster curiosity and belonging

After settling on that, I took a look at what's available in the market with that goal, exploring apps like **Spotted by Locals** and **Mapstr**.

Things worth mentioning:

Both apps have a **strong focus on touristic** or standard information;

Spotted by Locals has **a certain number of spotters** that can share their experiences with others as well as **limited cities** (only Lisbon and Porto for Portugal);

Mapstr feels more like an "**archiver**" **app**, with the main focus on saving places as 'done' or 'to try';

5 W's + H behind the solution

- **WHAT** — Outdoor activities are important for people's mental and physical health, especially post-pandemic.
- **WHO** — **Archetypes:** the wanderer, the displaced, the local connector and the traveler
- **WHERE** — **On the go, while walking**. It could be a purposeful outing or a spontaneous discovery
- **WHEN** — For **everyday moments** or **occasional discoveries**
- **WHY** — To invite a **deeper connection** between people and their surroundings

But, how?

With a **different way** to look at **POIs**

the USP

We all know POIs (Points of Interest) as landmarks like tourist spots, scenic views, or historical sites, etc. But what if a POI was something more personal - like Dona Aida? Or anything **that evokes a feeling or a sense of belonging?**

The goal with these POIs is to create an informal network of things people might otherwise overlook

People · Hidden · Must See · Zen · Sounds · Nature · Buildings · Art · ...

Given the broad and diverse potential audience for this idea, a rigid persona framework felt too limiting.
So, for this project, I decided to to define possible archetypes

Wandereres
Love to explore without a set destination

Displaceds
Someone new to a city, seeking familiarity

Local Connectors
Help others see the city through local eyes

Traveleres
Explore cities with curiosity and an open mind

Where do their paths meet?

Step Out

Turning spaces into places, step by step

Users can browse through the homepage for POIs

And see other user's map directly on their profile or explore through items and collections

A friendly nudge

With the aim of feeling users from the need of checking their phone while walking, notifications play a primary role on this app.

When they are near a POI from someone they follow, a location-based notification alerts them.

Users can also dive into the map anytime to uncover new POIs

Type it or talk it? Both

To cater to different needs, they **interaction on the go, also adding a personal touch to POIs** - whether sharing a story, capturing a sound, or expressing emotions, text can't convey.

Step Out is built on the belief that a city's true essence lies in the personal connections and perspectives that individuals bring to it.

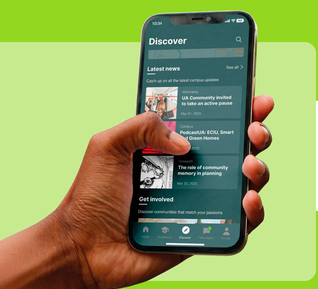
Everyone sees and cares for things differently, everyone has different taste and, as places have this ever-changing nature, the possibilities are endless. Whether it is where we live or where we are going tomorrow, Step Out allow us to connect with places through other people's eyes.

All of this, while getting some steps in ;)

UAMobile

Rethinking University of Aveiro's mobile app

Redesign
Revisited in 2024 for improvements
Designed in Jan'23



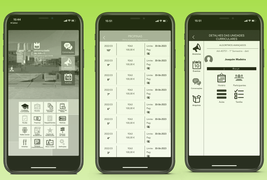
During my time at university, I often wondered why our mobile app **was so outdated**.

As a practice exercise, I redesigned the app to make the app **more practical for students** and **better aligned with the university's visual identity** (e.g., its website).

Disclaimer: The University of Aveiro has since launched a new version. This redesign was based on the previous one.

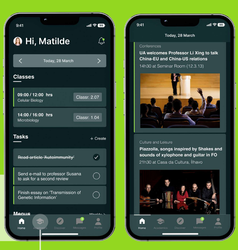
A quick diagnosis: **spotting the main issues**

By evaluating the existing design, I identified key pain points and usability challenges that guided my approach to the redesign

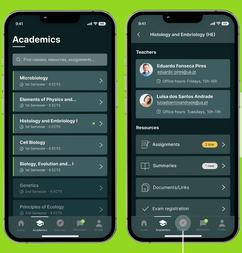


1. The **absence of a navigation menu** increased the number of clicks required to complete simple tasks.
2. The information **lacked a clear hierarchy**, which made it difficult to quickly absorb and retain key info.
3. The **inconsistency in the design** affected the overall coherence and usability of the app.
4. Improving some features could **improve the app's overall usefulness** and benefit students.

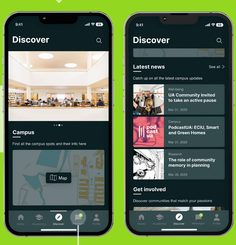
With this in mind,
how did I tackle these issues?



Upon opening the app, students can now **instantly view essential day-to-day information**, including their schedule, tasks, daily menus, and upcoming events.



Students can browse curricular units by semester, with each unit providing all **the essential information to support their learning.**



I decided to add a 'Discover' section, to help students (specially new ones) **navigate the campus and stay updated with relevant information**.

Students can now access **messages from their professors directly within the app**, ensuring they stay informed with important updates in a more immediate and convenient way.

*To keep the app aligned with institutional communication, replying to messages redirects students to their email app, ensuring a seamless and official exchange

Although this project was a practice exercise, I believe these improvements could **positively impact** students' day-to-day lives. By enhancing clarity and usability, this redesign **aimed to turn this app into a reliable right hand** - creating a more efficient experience.

Images used in the app (except for profile pictures) were sourced from the University of Aveiro's website.

And that’s a wrap, for now!

Thank you

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